

Daily Bible Note

Date: May 24, 2026

I. Today's Reading

NKJV: 1 Corinthians 7:25–40

25 Now concerning virgins: I have no commandment from the Lord; yet I give judgment as one whom the Lord in His mercy has made trustworthy.

26 I suppose therefore that this is good because of the present distress—that it is good for a man to remain as he is:

27 Are you bound to a wife? Do not seek to be loosed. Are you loosed from a wife? Do not seek a wife.

28 But even if you do marry, you have not sinned; and if a virgin marries, she has not sinned. Nevertheless such will have trouble in the flesh, but I would spare you.

29 But this I say, brethren, the time is short, so that from now on even those who have wives should be as though they had none,

30 those who weep as though they did not weep, those who rejoice as though they did not rejoice, those who buy as though they did not possess,

31 and those who use this world as not misusing it. For the form of this world is passing away.

32 But I want you to be without care. He who is unmarried cares for the things of the Lord—how he may please the Lord.

33 But he who is married cares about the things of the world—how he may please his wife.

34 There is a difference between a wife and a virgin. The unmarried woman cares about the things of the Lord, that she may be holy both in body and in spirit. But she who is married cares about the things of the world—how she may please her husband.

35 And this I say for your own profit, not that I may put a leash on you, but for what is proper, and that you may serve the Lord without distraction.

36 But if any man thinks he is behaving improperly toward his virgin, if she is past the flower of youth, and thus it must be, let him do what he wishes. He does not sin; let them marry.

37 Nevertheless he who stands steadfast in his heart, having no necessity, but has power over his own will, and has so determined in his heart that he will keep his virgin, does well.

38 So then he who gives her in marriage does well, but he who does not give her in marriage does better.

39 A wife is bound by law as long as her husband lives; but if her husband dies, she is at liberty to be married to whom she wishes, only in the Lord.

40 But she is happier if she remains as she is, according to my judgment—and I think I also have the Spirit of God.

II. Key Summary

- Paul says "the time is short" — a reminder not to cling too tightly to the things of this world, because everything we see around us is temporary
 - Getting married or staying single are both fine choices; Paul's point is not to forbid marriage but to encourage everyone to follow God wholeheartedly in whatever situation they're in
 - Single people have more freedom to focus on serving God without divided attention, but Paul calls this his personal advice — not a command — since each person has their own calling and gifting
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III. Passage Analysis

The Time Is Short — Living with an Eye on What Lasts

*The Greek word Paul uses for "short" is *sustello* — it refers to sails being pulled in as a ship approaches the harbor. "The harbor is near, and the sails are shortened!" It's a picture of readiness: not giving up on the voyage, but recognizing that the destination is close. [1]*

This isn't a reason to stop caring about school, friendships, or the things happening in your life right now. It's a quiet reminder: when you know these things are temporary, you start making decisions differently. You don't let any single thing take over your whole heart, because you know there's something bigger worth giving it to.

Serving God Without Distraction — Finding Space for What Matters Most

The unmarried person "can more conveniently attend to these things" — hearing God's word, reading it, meditating on it, and praying — without their attention being pulled elsewhere. [2]

Paul isn't putting marriage down. He even repeats multiple times, "this is my opinion, not a command." His real question is simpler than it sounds: *How much of your heart actually has room for God right now?* Whether you're in a relationship or not, whether life is calm or chaotic — that question stays the same.

IV. Reflection Question

Have you ever had a season where one person, one goal, or one thing almost completely took over your headspace — and looking back, do you think it was worth it?

If you knew that most things in life are temporary, what's one thing you'd actually want to give your whole heart to?

References

[1] Enduring Word, David Guzik, <https://enduringword.com/bible-commentary/1-corinthians-7/>

[2] BibleHub Commentaries, Gill's Exposition,
https://www.biblehub.com/commentaries/1_corinthians/7-32.htm